

How to Use AI to Build a \$10K/Month Online Training Business

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Executive Summary

Brandon Carter — multi-million-dollar online trainer and 15,000-student mentor — teaches a complete AI-powered system: niche down ruthlessly, create targeted content using viral-video analysis, convert attention into leads with free PDF magnets and DM automations, close on Zoom sales calls, and retain clients through daily accountability check-ins.

Contents

-  Why AI Won't Replace Trainers — But Will Separate Winners From Losers
-  The Disruption Pattern: Kodak, Borders, Taxis, Blockbuster
-  Secret 1 — Pick a Hyper-Specific Niche
-  Secret 2 — Build Your AI Attention Machine (Niche Hacking + Content System)
-  Secret 3 — Turn Attention Into Leads (Profit PDF + DM Automation)
-  Turning Leads Into Sales (DM Scripts + Sales Calls)
-  How Online Training Actually Works (Accountability Coaching Model)
-  Pricing Models and the Math to \$10K/Month
-  Bonus Strategy: Facebook Group Hacking
-  Bonus Strategy: Testimonial Harvest (Starting With Zero Clients)
-  Bonus Strategy: Makeover Madness (Starting Out of Shape)
-  Real Forge Software Demo
-  Batching Content for People With 9-to-5 Jobs
-  When and How to Use Paid Ads
-  High Ticket Trainer 2.0 (HTT) — Program Overview and Offer
-  Closing Mindset: Eagles vs. Pigeons

Why AI Won't Replace Trainers — But Will Separate Winners From Losers

7:34

- Core argument: AI will **not** replace online trainers within the next 20 years
 - People can already access unlimited free fitness information — they still don't act on it
 - Obesity rates went **up** after ChatGPT launched in late 2022 — information is not the problem

- No app can replicate the accountability a real human coach provides
- What AI *will* do is help trainers get more done in less time
 - Writing scripts, generating content ideas, building lead magnets, setting up automations
- The failure mode most trainers fall into:
 - They have ChatGPT, Instagram, CapCut, ManyChat, Go High Level — but use them generically
 - Posts read like "AI slop" — audiences can tell and it attracts no clients
- Requirement: a few hours per day of real work; this is not a 15-minutes-a-week scheme

The Disruption Pattern: Kodak, Borders, Taxis, Blockbuster 11:49

- **Kodak** invented the digital camera in 1975 but refused to disrupt their film revenue — went bankrupt
- **Borders** dominated book retail but ignored Amazon — went out of business
 - Amazon started selling only books, took a narrow niche, then expanded to everything
- **Taxis** had cars, licenses, airports, street monopoly — Uber had the *software* and won
- **Blockbuster** was killed by Netflix
- The recurring pattern:
 - Old way works → new tool emerges → most people ignore it → a few use it aggressively → market rewards the adapters
- Darwin quote reframed: "Survival of the fittest" means the species that can *adapt* survives, not the strongest
- Takeaway: trainers still using generic content and manual follow-up are the Kodak of fitness

Secret 1 — Pick a Hyper-Specific Niche 30:39

- Generic trainers lose; specialists win — always
 - Compare: "I help people lose weight" vs. "I help dads over 35 lose 25 lbs without living in the gym"
 - Specialist analogy: general doctor (Dr. A) vs. heart surgeon (Dr. B) — Dr. B makes far more money
 - Restaurant analogy: 24-hour diner (everything) vs. STK steakhouse (only steak) — during the pandemic, the diner closed; STK made more money
- The three niche variables — **who, what, how**:
 - **Who** you help — start with gender (men or women), then narrow to an age range
 - Recommended age range: a 10-year window (e.g., 25–35 or 35–45) — marketing to a 20-year-old is completely different from marketing to a 40-year-old
 - Can get more specific: moms, dads, former athletes, blue-collar workers, desk-job workers, entrepreneurs
 - **What** problem you help them solve — not "get in shape"; go deeper
 - E.g., get ripped, lose fat and get toned, optimize hormones, lose weight without the gym
 - **How** you help them solve it — your unique mechanism

- E.g., intermittent fasting + HIIT, ketogenic diet + slow cardio (walking), calorie tracking with favorite foods
- Why gender matters for marketing — Procter & Gamble owns both Old Spice (men) and Secret (women)
 - The deodorant inside is chemically identical; only the branding differs
 - Even a billion-dollar company can't market the same product to both genders simultaneously
 - "When Old Spice put a carnivorous mammal biting into the name holding a weapon, they were going all in on men"
- Brandon's own niche evolution:
 - 2009: Men aged 20–30 / get ripped / intermittent fasting + HIIT → marketed around attractiveness to women
 - Later: Men aged 30–40 / get ripped / ketogenic diet + low-intensity cardio (walking) → marketed around energy, longevity, avoiding embarrassment with kids
- Student example — **Jen** (busy moms):
 - Bio: "I help busy moms lose fat and get toned at home"
 - Featured her kids and husband in videos; all workouts were home-based
 - A mom watching immediately thinks "this is for me" — niche creates instant recognition
 - April revenue: **\$49,927**; May was already at \$12,577 within days
- Niche benefits compound:
 - Busy dads are friends with other dads → sharing accelerates following growth
 - All testimonials start to look like the same person with the same problem → social proof is maximally relevant
 - Fewer direct competitors because you've sliced the market multiple times
 - When running paid ads, you can target gender + age + interest = your exact niche

The specialist always wins. Once you cut to men 35–45 who want keto + slow cardio, there are almost no competitors — and the prospect can't price-shop because almost no one else does exactly what you do.

- **AI prompt to find your niche** (screenshot and paste into ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, or Grok):
 - *"Help me pick a profitable niche. Ask me 7 questions to identify who I can help, what problem I solve, what method I use, and what result I can confidently deliver. Give me 5 niche options."*

Secret 2 — Build Your AI Attention Machine (Niche Hacking + Content System) 57:01

- The algorithm has been democratized — accounts with 1,000 followers can get 100K+ views
 - Follower count matters far less than content quality
- **Niche Hacking** — how to model what's already working:

- Step 1: Go to Instagram and search terms relevant to your niche (e.g., "men's weight loss tips")
- Step 2: Look for **outlier videos** — defined as a video with 5–10× more views than the creator's follower count
 - Example: a creator with 100K followers gets 5M views → outlier
 - Example: Greg (Kino Body) with 1.5M followers gets 2M views → NOT an outlier
- Step 3: Install the Chrome extension **Sorter for TikTok and Instagram** (~\$19) to sort by view count and see engagement data on any profile
- Step 4: Download the outlier video
- Step 5: Upload to **Gemini** (the only major AI that can actually watch a video; ChatGPT and Claude cannot)
- Step 6: Use prompt: *"Analyze this viral video. Tell me why it went viral and write out the transcript for me."*
- Step 7: Follow-up prompt: *"I help men aged 30–40 get ripped with the ketogenic diet. Make me a version of this script that works for my niche and target market."*
- You are NOT stealing — you are being influenced/inspired, like musicians learning from existing chord progressions before writing original songs
- **Script/transcript prompt** (screenshot this):
 - *"Analyze this viral transcript. Identify the hook, pacing, structure, emotional trigger, CTA, and why it worked. Then create a reusable script template I can use for my niche."*
- Brandon uses a voice transcription tool called **Whisper Flow** to dictate prompts instead of typing
- Once you know your niche, you never have to guess what to post again — run this process repeatedly
- Good niche-specific content examples vs. generic:

Generic (doesn't convert)	Niche-specific (creates buying intent)
"3 fat loss tips"	"3 fat loss mistakes dads make"
"Full body workout"	"40-minute workout for entrepreneurs"
"How to build muscle"	"How former athletes can get their body back"

- Initially, niche content may get fewer total views — that's fine; it attracts the *right* people who share it within their community

Secret 3 — Turn Attention Into Leads (Profit PDF + DM Automation) 72:34

- **Views are not the goal. Leads are the goal.**
- The content-to-client workflow:
 - Post content → tell viewers to **comment a keyword** → DM automation sends them a free resource → conversation begins → sales call → close
- **The Profit PDF** (aka lead magnet):
 - A short, useful guide tailored to your niche that helps them move toward their goal

- Includes a CTA at the end to book a call with you
- Examples of good lead magnets for specific niches:
 - 3-day fat loss plan for former athletes
 - Grocery list for moms trying to lose weight
 - Best workout split for dads
 - Meal plan template for busy entrepreneurs
 - Macro calculator for men doing keto
 - 7-day vegan challenge checklist
- Kelly Nicole Fit example: "Want me to help you calculate the exact macros you need? Comment MACROS."
 - Post got 342 comments — all leads; automated DM sends the PDF
 - Kelly made **\$2 million** in one year from online training using this system
- **How to build a Profit PDF with AI in minutes:**
 - Step 1: Have AI (e.g., Gemini or ChatGPT) write a short ebook from your niche-relevant script or caption
 - Prompt: *"This caption you wrote for me — rewrite it into a short ebook and include a CTA at the end to book a call with me to help them accomplish their fitness goals."*
 - Alternative: *"Interview me on this topic. Ask me one question at a time. Once you have all the information, take my words and turn them into an ebook."*
 - Step 2: Copy the text into **Gamma AI** (gamma.app)
 - Select "Plain Text" → paste → choose "Preserve Exact Text" → select Document format → pick a template → Generate
 - Gamma auto-generates a designed PDF with images; you can still edit, rearrange, and add images
 - Step 3: Download as PDF
 - Step 4: Connect to **ManyChat** or **Go High Level**
 - Go High Level is more powerful — can auto-book sales calls via AI in the DMs, not just deliver the PDF
- Double benefit of lead magnets:
 - Gets you leads (DM conversations with interested people)
 - Boosts content performance — comments = engagement signals = Instagram pushes the post to more people
 - Eliminates fear of being "salesy" — you're giving something away for free

Turning Leads Into Sales (DM Scripts + Sales Calls) 88:55

- After the automated PDF delivery, manually enter the DM conversation
- DM conversation flow:
 - Open: deliver the free resource
 - Question 1: *"Hey, what are your main fitness goals right now?"*

- Question 2 (if not already answered): *"What have you tried so far?"* — **skip if they already told you**
- Question 3: *"In your opinion, what do you think has been stopping you from accomplishing those goals?"* — skip if already answered
- If you have testimonials: share a relatable client story — "I had a client just like you, same problem, here's what happened..."
- Pitch: *"I can definitely help you with that. When do you have time to jump on a call?"*
- Why sales calls are necessary:
 - People won't spend \$997–\$1,997 from a link in a bio or a DM alone
 - Trust must be established in person (Zoom) — "you wouldn't marry someone you only talked to over DM"
- Testimonial stacking advantage of a niche:
 - All your testimonials look like the same person with the same problem → max relevance when shown to a prospect
- Brandon's sales credibility:
 - Has been doing fitness sales online longer than anyone he knows — started at age 17, 10+ years before Alex Hormozi
 - Paid Jordan Belfort (Wolf of Wall Street) **\$25,000** to spend a weekend reviewing and improving his already million-dollar sales scripts
 - Those refined scripts are included in HTT

How Online Training Actually Works (Accountability Coaching Model) 94:37

- Online training ≠ Zoom workouts — it's:
 - Providing a customized training plan and nutrition/diet strategy
 - Client executes independently (workouts and diet on their own)
 - Trainer monitors daily and provides accountability
- **The real product is accountability**, not information
 - Clients can get any workout or diet plan for free — they won't do it without someone watching
 - "Our job as online trainers is to be accountability coaches"
- Daily accountability process Brandon uses:
 - Every morning: check if client hit their macros and logged their workout (Google Sheets or any online training software)
 - If they did: "Good job hitting your macros yesterday — let's keep that momentum"
 - If they didn't: "What happened with the diet yesterday? How can we get you back on track?"
 - Knowing they'll be checked on causes clients to behave better — teacher-leaving-the-classroom analogy
- Additional coach responsibilities:
 - Weekly check-in calls (Zoom)
 - Adjusting the plan as client makes progress or plateaus

- Client capacity per trainer: **~50 clients maximum** for one person before needing to hire help
 - HTT teaches how to hire and scale beyond 50
- "Everything works if they do it" — Brandon has seen clients get great results with vegan, carnivore, IIFYM, portion control, calisthenics
 - For regular people (not pro athletes or bodybuilders), any reasonable plan works if followed
 - Student Mattie Cochland: had clients track diet and walk 10,000 steps/day — nothing else — and they lost weight

Pricing Models and the Math to \$10K/Month 79:16

- Courses don't work for \$10K/month:
 - Average course sells for ~\$50; you'd need to sell **200 courses per month** to new buyers — nearly impossible
- Online coaching pricing structures:

Format	Price	Clients Needed for ~\$10K/Month
16-week program	\$997	~10 new clients/month (recurring after 4 months)
Monthly retainer	\$297/month	~33 clients
Weekly	\$80/week	~31 clients

- In practice you'll have a mix of all three — plan for **30–40 total active clients** to hit \$10K/month
- At \$80/week with 25 clients for a full year = **\$104,000/year**
- Every new client is a recurring revenue raise — unlike selling a course once
- You do NOT need millions of followers for 30–40 clients
- Three main reasons trainers fail:
 - No clear niche
 - No consistent lead generation system
 - No follow-up system

Bonus Strategy: Facebook Group Hacking 2:05:35

- **Fastest way to get clients with a small following** — invented by Brandon
- Concept: instead of waiting for your niche to come to you, go *to where your niche already is*
 - Facebook groups exist with millions of members around every fitness niche
- Student example — **Corey Armstrong** (intermittent fasting niche):
 - Started with ~1,000 followers
 - Joined ~100 Facebook IF groups
 - Posted using a specific copywriting formula Brandon teaches
 - Got massive engagement (far more than his own page) from audiences already interested in IF

- Went into DMs with those commenters → booked calls → closed clients
- Made this his **primary revenue source until his following grew to 300K+**
- Eventually made **\$470,000 in one year**
- Student example — **Chris** (older guys + keto niche):
 - Instagram got deleted — pivoted entirely to group hacking
 - Joined keto Facebook groups, posted before/after with niche-relevant captions
 - Consistently hit \$20K/month just from group hacking
 - Full module on group hacking inside HTT with Chris teaching his exact method
- Key rules:
 - There's a specific post structure/copywriting formula — you can't just post anything
 - Post must generate engagement AND naturally lead into DM conversations
 - Teach something in the post, then prompt comments (same CTA structure as your reels)

Bonus Strategy: Testimonial Harvest (Starting With Zero Clients) 2:44:31

- For people who have no testimonials yet
- Process:
 - Step 1: Find **at least 5 people** to train for free for 1 month — reach out to friends/family or post publicly
 - Step 2: Target the most out-of-shape people you can find
 - The more excess fat someone has, the faster they lose weight → faster, more dramatic results for testimonials
 - Example: client lost 75 lbs in 70 days (he was obese)
 - Step 3: Get their results; accept that some will drop off — aim to get **2–3 to the finish line**
 - Step 4: **The only time Brandon recommends offering a discount** — offer those finishers 50% off to continue
 - E.g., \$150 (half of \$297/mo) or \$40/week (half of \$80/week)
 - Most finishers will say yes — they already know their life with and without your coaching
 - Step 5: Use their results as testimonials to attract paying clients from content and DMs
- Bonus: these free clients may refer their friends — your first paying referrals often come from free clients

Bonus Strategy: Makeover Madness (Starting Out of Shape) 1:54:43

- For trainers who aren't in peak shape yet
- Concept: **publicly document your own transformation** — you become your first testimonial
- Structure:
 - Pick a short time frame (30, 60, or 90 days) and commit to a visible transformation
 - Post daily: show your meals, explain why you're eating them; walk through your workouts
 - Give weekly progress updates (before/after at weeks 1, 2, 3, 4)

- Bring your audience on the journey like a personal reality show — think *The Biggest Loser* format
- **Don't wait until you're done to start selling** — once people are invested in your journey, DM those cheering you on
 - "Hey, if you want to join this journey with me, DM me [keyword]"
- At the end: post the full before/after and use it as your primary piece of social proof
- Student example — **Curtis** (school principal):
 - Joined HTT at 300 lbs; lost 60 lbs; signed 7 clients while working 14-hour days
 - Did Makeover Madness to get his first clients
- Brandon's personal example:
 - Got fat on purpose with a friend, spent 90 days gaining weight, then did a 2-week fat loss sprint
 - "It was the most money I ever made"
- Why it works even if you're not ripped:
 - Someone who was heavy can speak to the specific struggles (airplane seats, perspiring, etc.) that a naturally lean trainer never experienced
 - Relatability + transformation arc = extremely shareable content
- Student Spencer example: 31,000 followers, got 500,000 views on his transformation video
- Student Corey Armstrong: was "a little fluffy," making \$5–8K/month; did Makeover Madness, never made under \$10K again, hit \$50K months

Real Forge Software Demo [2:09:13](#)

- Brandon built a proprietary software called **Real Forge** — included free with HTT
- Features:
 - **Dashboard/Niche Setup**: input your target demographic (e.g., "males 25–35"), tone (e.g., "high energy coach"), problem (e.g., "burning fat and building muscle"), and method (e.g., "ketogenic diet and bodybuilding")
 - **Idea Generator**: click "Generate 10 Ideas" → trained on the Instagram algorithm → outputs 10 detailed content ideas with script outlines and multiple hook options
 - **Script Generator**: select an idea, click "Generate Full Script" → full script written for your niche
 - **Content Kanban Board**: tracks each piece of content through 5 stages
 - Ideas → Scripted → Filmed → Edited → Scheduled/Posted
 - **Scheduler/Calendar**: drag content cards between stages; auto-places in the correct stage if already scripted
 - Unlimited idea generation — run it as many times as needed
- Designed specifically for online trainers; not a generic tool

Batching Content for People With 9-to-5 Jobs [1:50:40](#)

- Instagram CEO confirmed: the more you post, the faster you grow — daily posting is the goal
- The 5 steps of creating a piece of content:
 - Ideas → Script → Film → Edit → Post
- The mistake: trying to do all 5 steps daily for each post — too slow, too inconsistent
- **Batching system** — dedicate separate blocks to each step:
 - Day 1: Generate all 7 content ideas for the week (use niche hacking + Real Forge)
 - Day 2: Script all 7 videos
 - Day 3: Film all 7 videos
 - Day 4: Edit all 7 videos
 - Day 5: Schedule and post all 7
 - In practice, Days 1 and 2 can often be combined into one session
- Brandon films one day per week and generates enough content for 3–4 posts per day
- Same short-form videos can be cross-posted to Instagram Reels, TikTok, and YouTube Shorts simultaneously — no one tracks or penalizes cross-posting

When and How to Use Paid Ads 2:51:13

- Brandon's recommendation: **don't start paid ads until you're making \$10K/month organically**
- Reason: ads can fail at any step in the funnel:
 - Bad content → ads won't fix it; you're just paying for people to see bad content
 - Good content but broken DM process → still no money
 - Good content, good DMs, but can't close on sales calls → still no money
 - Once you're at \$10K/month, all systems are proven — then ads just pour gas on the fire
- Exception: if a specific reel is already performing well organically, you can boost it sooner
- **Never hit the Boost button on Instagram** — it's designed to take money from people who don't understand ad platforms
- Use **Meta Ads Manager** instead:
 - Connect your Instagram account
 - Target options: gender, age range, interests (= your niche exactly), location
 - Advanced options:
 - Promote only to your existing followers
 - Promote only to people who engaged with your content
 - Upload a list of engaged users → Meta creates a **Lookalike Audience** of similar people
 - **Follower ads strategy**: run ads with objective = followers, targeted to your niche → grows your page with the right people
 - If you have a Profit PDF set up in your reels, even follower ads will generate lead magnet requests
- Brandon has spent **over \$10 million in ads** across his career



High Ticket Trainer 2.0 (HTT) — Program Overview and Offer [1:40:28](#)

- **Price:** one-time payment of **\$997**
- **Money-back guarantee:** 30 days — watch every video, post 14 days in a row with CTAs; if not satisfied, full refund
- **Curriculum (11 modules):**
 - Module 1 — Mindset: discipline, identity, consistency, raising standards, building confidence to post
 - Module 2 — Niche: how to pick, validate, and dial in your niche with AI prompts; one-on-one coach help available
 - Module 3 — Algorithm: how it works, equipment needed (phone, basic light, mic), 15 proven viral styles, 3 viral structures, AI-powered idea generation
 - Module 4 — Shoot & Edit: live demos of iPhone filming and editing short-form content
 - Module 5 — AI Lab: how to create AI images, AI video, and AI music for content
 - Module 6 — Interview with Kelly Nicole Fit: broke down her journey from zero to **\$2 million/year** as an online trainer
 - Module 7 — Coaching Program Setup: program structure, apps/software, recurring payment setup, coaching agreements, consultation forms, workout and meal plan creation, using AI to speed everything up
 - Module 8 — **9 Proven Client-Getting Strategies** (only a few were covered in the free training)
 - Module 9 — AI Sales System: DM scripts, 10-minute Zoom script, 60-minute Zoom script, objection handling role plays, creating an AI sales assistant
 - Module 10 — Follow-Up System: system for following up with leads who didn't buy immediately ("the big money is in the follow-up")
 - Module 11 — Business/Money Management: LLC setup, taxes, payment processing, keeping the money
- **Bonuses included:**
 - **Real Forge software** (lifetime access) — AI content planning tool built specifically for online trainers
 - Facebook Group Hacking Masterclass — with student Chris co-teaching
 - Facebook Ads Course for Online Trainers ("the only one that exists specifically for online trainers")
 - TikTok Ads Course for Online Trainers (same claim)
 - Simple Story Sales System
 - 30-Day Challenge Funnel
 - Social media growth hacks (Brandon has ~1M YouTube subscribers, ~1M Instagram followers, 400K TikTok)
 - **4 live weekly calls with Brandon** (Wednesdays at 11am) — he reviews your content and sales calls live; replays available if you miss
 - **1-on-1 strategy session** with a Brandon coach (book immediately upon joining)
 - Lifetime updates to curriculum
- **Stated value:** \$12,979; actual price: \$997 one-time
- Payment plans available (check the link)

- Capacity is limited because each student gets a one-on-one coach
- **Student results mentioned:**
 - Kelly Nicole Fit: \$20K/month at age 23 within 6 months; \$2M/year later
 - Myron Gains (Fresh & Fit podcast): \$7K first 30 days while still employed full-time by the government; \$40K/month part-time before the podcast
 - Karen Sutton (former Marine, ex-Equinox): \$245K in one year, 100% online
 - Jazz: ~\$190K in his first year using AI strategies
 - Corey Armstrong: \$470K last year; started broke, joined with his last dollars
 - Deja Lewis: first client within days of joining; moved from Atlanta to Colombia living as a digital nomad
 - Will: \$32K+ in his first month, had never trained anyone before
 - Curtis (school principal, 14-hour days): lost 60 lbs, signed 7 clients
 - One Ches AP Trucker: \$10K+/month working 80 hours/week as a trucker
 - Jonathan: first client in 12 days, already on client #3 (recurring revenue)
 - Charlie Diesel: under 100 followers when he joined; 8 clients within his first month
 - Anna Quinn: \$10K in her first 8 days of February

Closing Mindset: Eagles vs. Pigeons 2:27:00

- Eagles vs. pigeons metaphor:
 - Pigeons fight over crumbs, eat from trash, wait for scraps — they live at the mercy of others
 - Eagles swoop down and take what they want — a salmon from the water, a bird from mid-flight
 - Unlike animals, humans get to **choose** which one they are
- Brandon's argument for action over fear:
 - Every time you let fear stop you from doing something you want, you practice being a coward — it becomes your default
 - Even if you fail, you can look yourself in the mirror and say "at least I tried"
 - If you don't try, you can never know what you're capable of
- Legacy framing: if you have children, they won't believe "you can do anything" if you yourself settled — pigeons don't give birth to eagles
- Risk reframe: 30-day money-back guarantee means the financial risk is nearly zero — the only real risk is staying where you are
- "You won't rise to your ambitions. You'll fall to your standards."
 - The students who plateau at \$10K/month do so because \$10K becomes comfortable — the ones who hit \$1M/year keep raising their minimum standard, not just their ambitions